

2.4.7 Breaks from traffic controller duties

Where having to stand at a station continuously for more than two hours, traffic controllers must be relieved from their duty after not more than 2 hours for a period of rest or “other duties” of at least 15 minutes.

“Other duties” does not include operation of a STOP / SLOW bat or manual PTCB to control traffic or any duties involving:

- standing still in one position, or controlling traffic with a traffic control device
- continuing to control traffic in a similar manner to operating the STOP / SLOW bat (e.g. be the lead traffic controller at an intersection under control and be instructing the other traffic controllers when to send/hold).

The intent of a break is to ensure a:

- physical break from operating the STOP / SLOW bat (not from all traffic control duties)
- mental break from perpetual STOP / SLOW activity (particularly in multi traffic control, heavy traffic volume situation), to reduce the likelihood of traffic controller error.

Longer rest/meal breaks will be dealt with in accordance with relevant industry awards, industrial agreements and WHS legislation.

2.5 What to Wear

2.5.1 General

This Guide provides flexibility by giving traffic controllers a range of clothing options to achieve a high visibility outcome and assist in ensuring safety of the traffic controller on a worksite. It is recommended clothing be chosen to achieve a high level of comfort for the traffic controller, taking into account environmental factors and specific worksite requirements.

In all cases personal safety of the traffic controller at the site must be the highest priority consideration.

Specified traffic controller clothing is intended to signify a person on site performing specific traffic controller duties and functions and must be in compliance with AS/NZS 4602.1. Traffic controller specific garments must be worn when performing traffic controller STOP / SLOW duties or while supervising a traffic controller in training, as the supervisor may be required to step in to perform duties.

Traffic controllers are required to have headwear appropriate to climactic conditions (e.g. wide-brimmed hats for sun protection, hard hats near construction or beanies in cold weather).

In cold weather, the use of garments such as jackets must not obscure a traffic controller vest required for identification.

The specified traffic controller clothing is also applicable to a traffic controller in training who is allocated to the worksite to undertake the practical component of their accreditation training course.

2.5.2 Clothing to comply with standards

All clothing and accessories worn by traffic controllers must be clean, in good order and not be faded. Where this Guide refers to an Australian/New Zealand Standard, the latest edition will apply. Therefore, where compliance to an Australian/New Zealand Standard is required, traffic controllers must wear clothing and materials that conform to the latest edition of that Australian/New Zealand Standard.

The relevant Australian and New Zealand Standards are summarised in Table 2.1.